

Write-up: Nmap comand lab_23/tcp open telnet

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Lab Link: <https://hackerdna.com/labs/learn-102>

| 1. Network Reconnaissance (Nmap Scan)

The work began with network reconnaissance to discover open ports on the target IP.

```
[live@parrot]-[~]
└─$ nmap 34.253.183.190
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-08-19 02:42 UTC
Nmap scan report for ec2-34-253-183-190.eu-west-1.compute.amazonaws.com
(34.253.183.190)
Host is up (0.25s latency).
Not shown: 998 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
23/tcp    open  telnet
80/tcp    open  http

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 18.54 seconds
```

Explanation: Nmap discovered two open ports: **23/tcp (telnet)** and **80/tcp (http)**. This is where an attacker gains initial visibility; the presence of Telnet highlights a major security vulnerability in communication protocols due to lack of encryption.

| 2. Exploitation (Telnet Service)

After discovering Telnet, I proceeded to attempt system access.

```
[live@parrot]-[~]
└─$ telnet 34.253.183.190
Trying 34.253.183.190...
Connected to 34.253.183.190.
Escape character is '^]'.

ip-10-0-1-125.eu-west-1.compute.internal login: user
```

Explanation: At this stage, I tried common usernames like admin and toor, but they failed. However, when I tried using user, the system let me log in directly without requiring a password. This is a severe misconfiguration vulnerability where the user account lacks any password protection.

| 3. Privilege Escalation

After successfully logging in as user, I looked for a way to escalate privileges to root.

```
ip-10-0-1-125:~$ whoami
user
ip-10-0-1-125:~$ su root
Password:
/home/user # whoami
root
/home/user # ls
flag-user.txt
/home/user # cat flag-user.txt
f47ac10b-58cc-4372-a567-0e02b2c3d479
/home/user #
```

Explanation: I typed su root to elevate privileges. The system prompted for a password, and successfully authenticated to grant root (administrator) rights. Following that, I gained full control of the system, located the flag-user.txt file, and retrieved the flag.

| 4. Conclusion & Flag

Flag Found: f47ac10b-58cc-4372-a567-0e02b2c3d479

Created by Mr system